# Sayorn Chin

chins@lafayette.edu | schinlfc.github.io | schinlfc | 0000-0002-5745-8595 | Google Scholar
Department of Economics, Lafayette College
Simon Center for Economics and Business
730 High Street, Easton, PA 18042 USA

Last Update: November 7, 2026

---

**Visa Status**

**Cambodia:** Citizenship, **United States:** Permanent Resident

**Current Positions**

**Assistant Professor**, Department of Economics, Lafayette College — Jul. 2023 – Present
**Data Science Fellow Affiliate**, Mountain Data Group — Jun. 2023 – Present

**Previous Positions**

**Data Scientist**, Mountain Data Group — May 2021 – May 2023
**Graduate Teaching Instructor**, Colorado State University — Jul. 2020 – May 2023
**Graduate Teaching Assistant**, Colorado State University — Aug. 2017 – May 2020
**Finance Assistant**, Colorado College — Feb. 2016 – Jan. 2017
**Data Research Analyst**, Colorado College — Jan. 2016 – May 2016

**Education**

**Ph.D., Economics**, Colorado State University — 2023
**M.A., Economics**, Colorado State University — 2019
**B.A., Mathematical Economics**, Colorado College — 2017

**Research Output**

**Peer-Reviewed Publications: Economics**

[1] Chin, S., Zahran, S., Keyes, C., & Mushinski, D. (2026). The longer reach of lead: Early childhood lead exposure and cognitive ability later-in-life. *Economics and Human Biology*, *63*, 101663.

[2] Chin, S., & Miller, R. (2026). Beyond income: Health, wealth, and racial welfare gaps among older Americans. *Demography*, *63*(1), 187–211.

[3] An, Y., Chin, S., & Miller, R. (2025). Growing old in rural America: Measuring late-life health and economic well-being. *Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, *31*, 100565.

[4] Miller, R., Chin, S., & Sedai, A. K. (2022). The welfare cost of late-life depression. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, *204*, 15–36.

**Peer-Reviewed Publications: Public Health**

[1] Perry, T., & Chin, S. (2026). The unregulated rise of kratom drinks: Emerging challenges and policy recommendations. *Public Health Reports*, 1–6.

[2] Perry, T., & Chin, S. (2026). Kratom drinks and consumption trends: Insights from Reddit. *Journal of Substance Use*, *31*(1), 124–132.

[3] Perry, T., & Chin, S. (2025). Kratom beverages online: Marketing narratives, content, dosing, and potential risks. *Substance Use & Misuse*, 1–4.

**Peer-Reviewed Publications: Economics Pedagogy**

[1] Chin, S., Io, K., Kırşanlı, F., & Perry, T. (2026). From cheating to learning: AI integration in introductory economics. *Journal of Economics Teaching*, *11*(2), 208–228.

**Working Papers**

[1] The Compensation of Conscience, with Sammy Zahran and Anders Fremstad. Under Review.

[2] Air Pollution and Crime: Heterogeneity by Offense Types and Exposure Intensity, with Salvador Lurbé and Prasiddha Shakya. Under Review.

[3] Loss or Gain from Separation? Wealth and Child Mental Health in Divorce Dynamics, with Solano Caffarena, Swarup Joshi, and Ashish Sedai.

[4] Maternal Lead Exposure and Birth Outcomes: Evidence from Natural Experiments in the Phase-out of Leaded Gasoline, with Sammy Zahran, Christopher Keyes, Yuulin An, and Susan Averett.

[5] The Effect of Leaded Gasoline on Infant Health: Evidence from NASCAR Fuel Transition, with Yuulin An and Sammy Zahran.

**Work in Progress**

[1] Lead Exposure and Heart-Disease Mortality in the United States, with Christopher Keyes, Bruce Lanphear, and Sammy Zahran.

[2] Tip Credit Effects on Employment, Earnings, and Establishments, with Vinicius Curti Cícero and Sammy Zahran.

[3] The Morning Advantage: Differential Returns to Sunlight Exposure on Well-being, with Sammy Zahran and Ray Miller.

[4] Excess Emissions and Infant Health: Evidence from Texas, with Susan Averett.

[5] Urban Heat Island and Birth Complications, with Yuulin An and Tim Komarek.

[6] Bringing Introductory Economics to Life: A Scaffolded Research Paper as Authentic Assessment in Introductory Economics, with Teresa Perry, Fatih Kırşanlı, and Kenese Io.

## Teaching Experience

**Lafayette College**

| | |
|---|---|
| ECON 215: Health Economics | FA 2025 |
| ECON 346: Economic Development | FA 2024, SP 2025, FA 2025, SP 2026 |
| ECON 251: Intermediate Microeconomics | FA 2023, SP 2024, FA 2024, SP 2025, SP 2026 |

**Colorado State University**

| | |
|---|---|
| ECON 202: Principles of Microeconomics | FA 2017, FA 2019, SM 2020, FA 2021 SP 2022, FA 2022, SP 2023 |
| ECON 204: Principles of Macroeconomics | SP 2018, FA 2018, SP 2019 SP 2020, FA 2020 |
| ECON 306: Intermediate Microeconomics | FA 2021, SP 2022 |
| ECON 304: Intermediate Macroeconomics | SP 2021 |
| ECON 335: Introduction to Econometrics | SM 2019 |
| ECON 460: Economic Development | FA 2021 |

## Research Advising

**Honors Thesis Advising**

Daniel Colden ('26) - Economics and History (Primary Advisor)
Benjamin Risley ('26) - Government and Law, Economics (Second Reader)

**Independent Study**

| | |
|---|---|
| Isabel Berkeley ('25) | Spring 2025 |
| Xinyuan Liang ('27) | Spring 2025 |
| Yi Luo ('26) | Spring 2025 |
| Justin Fretz ('25) | Spring 2025 |

**EXCEL Scholars/Bergh Fellows/Research Assistants**

| | |
|---|---|
| Fiorella Garcia Sanchez ('27) | Summer 2026 |
| Yi Luo ('26) | Fall 2025 |
| Ava Sydell ('27) | Summer 2025 |
| Daniel Colden ('26) | Winter 2025 |
| Naya Kurdy ('25) | Fall 2024, Spring 2025 |
| Vanika Sok ('26) | Summer 2024, Fall 2024 |

## College Service

| | |
|---|---|
| Artificial Intelligence Club Advisor | Summer 2025 – Present |
| International Faculty & Staff Community of Practice Board Member | Spring 2025 – Present |

## Department Service

| | |
|---|---|
| Scholarship Revision Working Group | Fall 2025 – Present |
| Co-organizer Department Honors Program | Fall 2024 – Present |

## Honors and Awards

| | |
|---|---|
| Student Government Superior Teaching Awards Nominee, Lafayette College | 2024 |
| Graduate Research Assistantship, Colorado State University | 2022 |
| Competition Committee Member, AFIT-AFEE 16th Annual Student Scholars Award | 2022 |
| Best Paper Award, AFIT-AFEE 16th Annual Student Scholars Award | 2021 |
| Graduate Teaching Assistantship, Colorado State University | 2017 – 2023 |
| Colorado College Financial Aid Award | 2013 – 2017 |
| Davis United World College Scholars Scholarship Award | 2013 – 2017 |
| United World College of Southeast Asia Scholarship Award | 2008 – 2013 |

## Conferences

| | |
|---|---|
| Eastern Economic Association, La Romana, Dominican Republic | 2026 |
| Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management, Seattle, WA | 2025 |
| Southern Economic Association 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL | 2025 |
| 14th Annual Conference on Teaching and Research in Economic Education, Denver | 2025 |
| Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C. | 2024 |
| 70th NARSC Meetings, San Diego, CA | 2023 |
| The 3rd Annual Conference of the Western Social Science Association 2021 (virtual) | 2021 |

## Other Conference Activities

| | |
|---|---|
| Eastern Economic Association, La Romana, Dominican Republic, *Discussant* | 2026 |
| ASSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA, *Session Chair: Artificial Intelligence* | 2026 |
| Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C., *Discussant* | 2024 |
| 70th NARSC Meetings, San Diego, CA, *Discussant* | 2023 |

## Workshops

| | |
|---|---|
| 7th Annual Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, FRB Atlanta, Orlando | 2025 |
| 6th Annual Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, FRB Atlanta, Clemson | 2024 |

## Media Mentions

Huss, Phoebe. "Once given out at USC, this banned, opioid-like product is still cropping up in California." *CalMatters*, March 17, 2026.

Reddy, Sumathi. "What You Need to Know About Kratom." *Wall Street Journal*, August 16, 2025.

"Teresa Perry, PhD: Academic Paper on the Rise of Kratom Tonic Products." *Kratom Sobriety Podcast*, episode 46.

## Invited Talks

| | |
|---|---|
| Colorado College Economic Department Seminar Series | 2026 |
| Dickinson College Economic Department Seminar Series | 2025 |
| AI in Economics Seminar Series at Royal Holloway, University of London (virtual) | 2025 |
| Keynote Speaker, APIME Graduation Celebration at Lafayette College | 2025 |
| Faculty Features: A Faculty Scholarship & Creativity Roundtable, Lafayette College | 2025 |
| Asian Cultural Association at Lafayette College | 2024, 2025 |
| The Hanson Center for Inclusive STEM Education at Lafayette College | 2024 |
| University of Wyoming, Knox College, University of New Hampshire | 2023 |

## Skills and Credentials

**Programming/Software**

Proficient in: Python, R, Stata, MySQL, Git/GitHub

**Certifications**

Good Clinical Practice Training for Social and Behavioral Research, Tools for Data Science, Python for Data Science, Python for Data Science & AI, Data Science Methodology, Database & SQL for Data Science, Data Analysis with Python, Machine Learning with Python, Data Visualization with Python, Python Project for Data Science

## Professional Affiliations

American Economic Association, American Society of Health Economists

## Professional Service

Referee for: *International Journal of Mental Health and Addiction* (2), *Regulation & Governance* (2), *Eastern Economic Journal*, *Journal of Family and Economic Issues*, *Economics and Human Biology* (3), *Energy Economics* (4), *World Development*, *Journal of Racial and Ethnic Health Disparities* (2)

External reviewer: Ph.D. Dissertation at Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur